

Ancient Civilizations

AI Tutor - History - Lesson 1

Cradles of Civilization

The earliest complex human societies arose near major rivers, where fertile soil supported farming and growing populations: Mesopotamia (Tigris-Euphrates), Egypt (Nile), the Indus Valley, and China (Yellow River).

Key Achievements

- **Mesopotamia** - invented writing (cuneiform) and early law codes.
- **Egypt** - built monumental pyramids and developed a solar calendar.
- **Indus Valley** - planned cities with advanced drainage systems.
- **Ancient China** - developed silk production and early bureaucracy.

Why Study Ancient History

These early civilizations established ideas - writing, law, government, agriculture - that still shape how societies function today.